# FOUNDER MODE · SEQUENCE OF PLAY · v2

2 to 6 founders · Ages 13+ (Junior 8-12 on its own sheet) · 45 to 60 minutes · tape inside the box lid

**SETUP (once, before Round 1)**

Each player: $5,000 cash · 1 Player Mat · 1 HQ Tile (Vacant) · 1 Cap Table clip at 100% · 1 chip row. Draw 3 Problem Cards, keep 1, match it to any Industry Card. Strong Match = 1 free Customer Token. Name your business on the mat. Shuffle the Chaos Deck (starts Round 3) and the Pitch Cards. Lay the 5 Investor Cards face-up on Investor Row. Trust Pool bowl at center.

**PHASE 1 · CHAOS (Rounds 3+)**

Draw 1 Market Chaos card. Read aloud. Apply immediately. Column shifts last one round unless stated. Home column: NORMAL, or BOOM if you hold a Mural Token.

**PHASE 2 · ACTIONS (each founder takes 2, in turn order)**

PITCH: draw a Pitch Card, pick one approach, add your Tier modifier, roll 2d6. Hit = 1 Customer Token. Doubles on a miss = customer anyway. HQ: pay $1,500, flip tile, add the $50 Rent chip. HIRE: pay $120, add an Employee chip ($60/$40); each Employee reads your strip +1 row at Settle; max 3. AUTOMATE at the Tech Hub: AI $3,000 · Tech $3,500 · others $5,000; flip tile, swap chips to AUTO, cap rises 12 to 15. MURAL at the Sovereign District: pay $2,000, home column becomes BOOM, put $1,000 in the Trust Pool. INVESTOR: meet the requirement, roll 7+ to close; a miss stays face-up. MENTOR: give any other founder 1 free action now; during a Sovereignty Run this replaces both your actions.

**PHASE 3 · SETTLE (everyone at once)**

Count Customer Tokens. Add +1 row per Employee chip (never past row 15; rows 13-15 need an Automated HQ). Read your active column on the Payout Strip. Collect from the bank. Food founders on Festival: collect Festival AND Normal. On Boom or Festival: put $20 in the Community Trust Pool.

**PHASE 4 · OVERHEAD (everyone at once)**

Pay the bank the total of your chips. Cannot pay = bankrupt: Comeback Loan $1,500 once per game, re-enter next round. Sovereignty check: Run declared + Settle exceeded Overhead = check one box. Any loss round resets the boxes. Three straight checks = SOVEREIGNTY: tower on the Skyline, record founder, business, and final cash in the Hall of Fame. Same-round tie: most cash on hand. Investors holding equity collect their percentage of your final cash.

# LOCKED RULINGS · these settle every dispute

### 1 · DOUBLES ARE ABSOLUTE

Fail a pitch but roll doubles? Referral anyway. The customer is yours. No modifier overrides this. No exceptions. Sometimes a weird connection beats a bad pitch.

### 2 · CAP TABLE FLOOR AT 51%

Total equity sold can never exceed 49%. If a deal would cross the line, it cannot close this turn. You always control your company. This is the most important cap table lesson in the box.

### 3 · SOVEREIGN FUND GATE

Took the Fund's money? Take at least 1 Mentor Action before declaring your Sovereignty Run. Hoarding it until the last turn is not allowed. Wealth means nothing if it never multiplies.

### 4 · COLUMN SHIFTS ARE NET AND BOUNDED

Shifts stack as one net move and stop at the printed strip edges (Recession and Festival). Nothing takes you off the card.

### 5 · TRUST POOL ROUNDING

When Sovereign District Scores fires, split evenly and round every payout UP to the nearest $5. Shortfall comes from the bank. Empty pool: $100 per Mural holder from the bank.

### 6 · BANKRUPTCY IS A CHAPTER

Nobody sits out. Comeback Loan: $1,500 once per game, re-enter next round. Comeback Story card re-enters you free. Failure is a chapter, not an ending.

### 7 · HANDS HAVE A CEILING. SYSTEMS DO NOT.

A manual founder holds at most 12 Customer Tokens and reads at most row 12. Automation lifts the cap to 15 customers, unlocks strip rows 13-15, and cuts overhead about 40%. Employee row bonuses never read past row 15. A business that needs your hands is a job. A business with systems is an asset.

### FOUNDER'S NOTE · TIER C EARLY GAME (advice, not a ruling)

*Your Strong Match token is your launchpad, not a bonus. Hunt low targets first: Hype Friend (Persona 6+, your 8+) and Church Director (Problem 6+, your 8+). Claim the free token, close two easy pitches, and you have 3 customers before Round 2 ends. Harder pitch, bigger revenue: that is the Tier C trade.*